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Display apparatus and method of manufacturing the same

Abstract

A display apparatus includes a base substrate including a display area and a peripheral area, a conductive layer formed on the base substrate in an entirety of the peripheral area and the display area, a buffer layer on the conductive layer, a thin film transistor on the buffer layer in the display area, an electrode in a contact hole that is formed through the buffer layer to expose a side surface of the conductive layer in the peripheral area, the electrode making contact the conductive layer, an insulating pattern in the contact hole on the electrode, and a wiring on the insulating pattern and electrically connected to the electrode.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S) (1) This is a divisional application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/592,138, filed Oct. 3, 2019 (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,239,300), the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/592,138 claims priority to and benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2018-0149132 under 35 U.S.C. § 119, filed on Nov. 28, 2018 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

(1) Embodiments relate to a display apparatus and a method of manufacturing the display apparatus.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Recently, a display apparatus having light weight and small size has been manufactured. A cathode ray tube (CRT) display apparatus has been used due to a performance and a competitive price. The CRT display apparatus may be limited as to size or portability. Therefore, a display apparatus such as a plasma display apparatus, a liquid crystal display apparatus, and an organic light emitting display apparatus has been highly regarded due to small size, light weight, and low-power-consumption.

SUMMARY

(3) Embodiments are directed to a display apparatus, including a base substrate including a display area and a peripheral area, a conductive layer formed on the base substrate in an entirety of the peripheral area and the display area, a buffer layer on the conductive layer, a thin film transistor on the buffer layer in the display area, an electrode in a contact hole that is formed through the buffer layer to expose a side surface of the conductive layer in the peripheral area, the electrode making contact the conductive layer, an insulating pattern in the contact hole on the electrode, and a wiring on the insulating pattern and electrically connected to the electrode.

(4) The electrode may be coupled to a ground voltage or a constant voltage.

(5) The peripheral area may include a pad area in which a pad portion electrically connected to a

- driving unit is disposed, and a folding area between the pad portion and the display area, and the contact hole may be in the folding area.
- (6) The buffer layer may not be present in the folding area.
- (7) The insulating pattern may cover a portion where the buffer layer is not present in the folding area.
- (8) The conductive layer may be an n⁺ doped amorphous silicon layer.
- (9) The base substrate may include a first polyimide layer, a barrier film layer on the first polyimide layer, and a second polyimide layer on the barrier film layer.
- (10) The base substrate may further include a second conductive layer disposed between the barrier film layer and the second polyimide layer or between the barrier film layer and the first polyimide layer, and the second conductive layer may be exposed by the contact hole, and the second conductive layer may contact the electrode.
- (11) The base substrate may include a first polyimide layer, a barrier film layer on the first polyimide layer, and a second polyimide layer on the barrier film layer, and the conductive layer may be disposed between the barrier film layer and the second polyimide layer or between the barrier film layer and the first polyimide layer.
- (12) The contact hole may be formed through the conductive layer so as to expose a side surface of the conductive layer, and the side surface of the conductive layer may contact the electrode.
- (13) The contact hole may be formed by removing a portion of the base substrate.
- (14) The thin film transistor may include an active pattern, a gate electrode, a source electrode and a drain electrode, and the display apparatus may further include a gate insulating layer disposed between the active pattern and the gate electrode, and an interlayer insulating layer between the gate electrode and the source and drain electrodes.
- (15) The display apparatus may further include a via insulating layer on the source and drain electrode, a first electrode on the via insulating layer and electrically connected to the drain electrode, a light emitting layer on the first electrode, and a second electrode on the light emitting layer.
- (16) The via insulating layer may cover the wiring.
- (17) The electrode may extend to an upper surface of the interlayer insulating layer, and the wiring may contact the electrode on the interlayer insulating layer.
- (18) Embodiments are also directed to a method of manufacturing a display apparatus, the method including forming a conductive layer on a base substrate, forming a buffer layer on the conductive layer, forming an active pattern on the buffer layer, forming an insulating layer on the active pattern, forming a contact hole by partially removing the insulating layer and the buffer layer to expose the conductive layer, forming an electrode that contacts the conductive layer in the contact hole, forming an insulating pattern on the electrode so as to expose a portion of the electrode, and forming a wiring electrically connected to the electrode on the insulating pattern.
- (19) The conductive layer may be an n⁺ doped amorphous silicon layer.
- (20) The method may further include forming a gate electrode on the insulating layer before forming the contact hole, and forming an interlayer insulating layer on the gate electrode. In forming the contact hole, the contact hole may be formed by partially removing the interlayer insulating layer, the insulating layer, and the buffer layer.
- (21) In forming the contact hole, a portion of the conductive layer may be removed to form the contact hole, and a side surface of the conductive layer may be exposed, and the side surface of the conductive layer may contact the electrode.
- (22) The base substrate may include at least one polyimide layer and at least one barrier film layer.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Features will become apparent to those of skill in the art by describing in detail example embodiments with reference to the attached drawings in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a plan view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a cross-sectional view taken along a line I-I' of FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a cross-sectional view taken along a line II-II' of FIG. 1;

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a display apparatus according to an example embodiment;

(10) FIGS. 9A to 9I illustrate cross-sectional views of the display apparatuses of FIGS. 1 to 3;

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates a block diagram of an electronic device according to an example embodiment;

(12) FIG. 11A illustrates a diagram of an example in which the electronic device of FIG. 10 is implemented as a television; and

(13) FIG. 11B illustrates a diagram of an example in which the electronic device of FIG. 10 is implemented as a smart phone.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(14) Example embodiments will now be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings; however, they may be embodied in different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein. Rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey example implementations to those skilled in the art. In the drawing figures, the dimensions of layers and regions may be exaggerated for clarity of illustration. Like reference numerals refer to like elements throughout.

(15) FIG. 1 is a plan view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(16) Referring to FIG. 1, the display apparatus may include a display area DA in which an image is displayed, a peripheral area PA surrounding the display area DA, a pad area PAa, and a folding area FA.

(17) The display area may be on a plane formed by a first direction D1 and a second direction D2 perpendicular to the first direction D1. The display apparatus may include a plurality of pixels in the display area DA. The display apparatus may further include a driving unit in the peripheral area PA for driving the pixels, a power supply unit for supplying power to the pixels, and a wiring unit for connecting the pixels and the driving unit.

(18) Each of the pixels may be provided as a minimum unit for displaying an image. The pixels may include a display element for emitting color light. For example, the display element may be a liquid crystal display device (LCD), an electrophoretic display device (EPD device), an electrowetting display device (EWD device), or an organic light emitting display device (OLED device). For convenience of explanation, the organic light emitting display apparatus will be described as an example of the display element.

(19) Each pixel may emit one of red, green, and blue colors, for example. Each of the pixels may emit colors such as cyan, magenta, yellow, and white, for example. These pixels will be described

below in detail with reference to FIGS. 2 and 3.

(20) The peripheral area PA may include the pad area PAa in which the pad portion PAD (to which the driving unit is connected) is disposed and the folding area FA disposed between the pad part PAD and the display area DA where the display apparatus is foldable. The folding area FA and the pad area PAa may extend in the first direction D1, respectively.

(21) An electrode GD may be in the folding area FA. The electrode GD may apply a constant voltage such as a ground voltage to a conductive layer on a base substrate. Thus, it may be possible to prevent a change in characteristics of the thin film transistor in the pixel due to an external factor (shield effect). A detailed description thereof will be described below with reference to FIGS. 2 and 3.

(22) FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional view taken along a line I-I' of FIG. 1. FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view taken along a line II-II' of FIG. 1.

(23) Referring to FIGS. 2 and 3, the display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a conductive layer **108**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulation layer TFE.

(24) The base substrate **100** may include transparent or opaque insulation materials. For example, the base substrate **100** may include a quartz substrate, a synthetic quartz substrate, a calcium fluoride substrate, a fluoride-doped quartz substrate, a sodalime glass substrate, a non-alkali glass substrate etc. In another implementation, the base substrate **100** may include a flexible transparent material such as a flexible transparent resin substrate, e.g., a polyimide substrate. The polyimide substrate may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104**, a second polyimide layer **106**, etc. For example, the polyimide substrate may have a configuration where the first polyimide layer **102**, the barrier film layer **104**, and the second polyimide layer **106**, are stacked on a rigid glass substrate.

(25) The conductive layer **108** may be on the base substrate **100**. The conductive layer **108** may be formed corresponding to an entirety of the display area DA and the peripheral area PA, and may be configured to apply a ground voltage or a constant voltage. For example, the conductive layer **108** may be an n⁺ doped amorphous silicon (a-Si) layer.

(26) The buffer layer **110** may be on the conductive layer **108**. The buffer layer **110** may be on the entire base substrate **100**. The buffer layer **110** may prevent the diffusion of metal atoms and/or impurities from the substrate **100** and the conductive layer **108** into the active pattern ACT. In addition, the buffer layer **110** may control a rate of heat transfer in a crystallization process for forming the active pattern ACT, which may help provide uniformity to the active pattern ACT.

(27) The active pattern ACT may be in the display area DA on the buffer layer **110**. The active pattern ACT may include amorphous silicon or polycrystalline silicon. In another embodiment, the active pattern ACT may include an oxide semiconductor. The active pattern ACT may include a drain region D and a source region S doped with impurities, and a channel region C between the drain region D and the source region S.

(28) The gate insulating layer **120** may be on the buffer layer **110** on which the active pattern ACT is disposed. The gate insulating layer **120** may cover the active pattern ACT on the buffer layer **110** and may be formed at substantially the same thickness along the profile of the active pattern ACT. The gate insulating layer **120** may include an inorganic insulating material such as a silicon compound or a metal oxide.

(29) The gate pattern may be on the gate insulating layer **120**. The gate pattern may include a signal line such as a gate line and a gate electrode GE to overlap with the active pattern ACT. The gate pattern may be formed using a metal, an alloy, a metal nitride, a conductive metal oxide, a transparent conductive material, or the like.

(30) The interlayer insulating layer **130** may be on the gate insulating layer **120** on which the gate

pattern is disposed. For example, the interlayer insulating layer **130** may sufficiently cover the gate pattern on the gate insulating layer **120**, and may have a substantially flat upper surface without forming a step around the gate pattern. In another implementation, the interlayer insulating layer **130** may cover the gate pattern on the gate insulating layer **120** and may be formed at substantially the same thickness along the profile of the gate pattern. The interlayer insulating layer **130** may include a silicon compound, a metal oxide, or the like. The interlayer insulating layer **130** may be formed of a plurality of layers.

(31) In the folding area FA of the peripheral region PA, the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110** may not be formed. Thus, the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110** may not be formed in the folding area FA, or may be removed in the folding area FA. The folding area FA is a folded part in the final product. If the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110** which are inorganic films, is formed in the folding area FA, damage to the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110**, such as cracks, may occur when the display apparatus is folded in the folding portion FA.

(32) In removing the inorganic films, a portion of the base substrate may be removed. For example, a portion of the second polyimide layer **106** in the folding area FA may be removed. Thus, a contact hole may be formed to expose the conductive layer **108** through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110**.

(33) The electrode GD may be disposed within the contact hole in the folding area FA. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole, which exposes a side surface of the conductive layer **108**, to be contacted with the side surface of the conductive layer **108** (side contact). Thus, the contact hole may be formed through the conductive layer **108** such that the side of the conductive layer **108** is exposed by the contact hole, and the side of the conductive layer **108** may be in contact the electrode GD. The electrode GD may be formed to extend to an upper surface of the interlayer insulating layer **130** and may be in contact with a wiring GL (to be described below) at a portion that is exposed by the insulating pattern **135** on the interlayer insulating layer **130**. The electrode GD may be formed using a metal, an alloy, a metal nitride, a conductive metal oxide, a transparent conductive material, or the like.

(34) In an implementation, the contact hole may be formed only up to the buffer layer **110**, so that the conductive layer **108** is not removed, and the electrode GD may contact the upper surface of the conductive layer **108**.

(35) A ground voltage or a constant voltage may be applied to the electrode GD. The conductive layer **108** electrically connected to the electrode GD may overlap with the thin film transistor TFT including the active pattern ACT and the gate electrode GE. Thus, the thin film transistor TFT may be prevented from being affected by external influences, such as static electricity, flowing from the base substrate **100** (shielding effect). The conductive layer **108** electrically connected to the electrode GD may overlap with the thin film transistor TFT including the active pattern ACT and the gate electrode GE, and may be disposed between the thin film transistor TFT and the base substrate **100**. Thus, it may be possible to prevent a change in the characteristics of the thin film transistor TFT from external influences (such as static electricity) flowing from the base substrate **100** (shielding effect).

(36) The insulating pattern **135** may be in the contact hole. Thus, the insulating pattern **135** may be formed corresponding to the portion in which the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110** are removed. The insulating pattern **135** may be formed to reduce a step with the interlayer insulating layer **130** in the folding area FA. In the drawing, for understanding, a step is shown as being formed with the interlayer insulating layer **130**, although the step may be minimized in practice. The insulating pattern **135** may include an organic insulating material and may not be easily damaged even when the folding area FA is folded.

(37) The data pattern may be on the interlayer insulating layer **130** on which the insulating pattern

135 is disposed. The data pattern may include a source electrode SE and a drain electrode DE of the thin film transistor TFT, and a signal line SL such as the wiring GL, and a data line. The data pattern may be formed using a metal, an alloy, a metal nitride, a conductive metal oxide, a transparent conductive material, or the like. For example, the data pattern may be formed of a metal such as copper, aluminum or the like having high conductivity. The data pattern may have a plurality of layered structures. For example, the data pattern may include a titanium layer, an aluminum layer on the titanium layer, and titanium on the aluminum layer.

(38) The wiring GL may extend in the second direction (refer to D2 in FIG. 1) in the peripheral region PA, and may intersect the insulating pattern **135**. The wiring GL may be configured to apply a ground voltage. For example, the wiring GL may extend to the pad area PAa and may be connected to a ground terminal PE_G of the pad portion (refer to PAD in FIG. 1) to receive the ground voltage from the driving unit. In addition, the wiring GL may extend to the display area DA to supply the ground voltage to the pixel structure.

(39) The via insulating layer **140** may be on the thin film transistor TFT. The via insulating layer **140** may be on the thin film transistor TFT. The via insulating layer **140** may cover the wiring GL. The via insulating layer **140** may be formed in a single layer structure, but may be formed in a multi-layer structure including at least two insulating layers. The via insulating layer **140** may be formed using an organic material such as a photoresist, an acrylic resin, a polyimide resin, a polyamide resin, or a siloxane-based resin.

(40) The light emitting structure **180** may include a first electrode **181**, a light emitting layer **182**, and a second electrode **183**.

(41) The first electrode **181** may be on the via insulating layer **140**. The first electrode **181** may include a reflective material or a transmissive material in accordance with the emission type of the display apparatus. In an example embodiment, the first electrode **181** may have a single layer structure or a multi-layer structure, which may include a metal film, an alloy film, a metal nitride film, a conductive metal oxide film, and/or a transparent conductive film.

(42) The pixel defining layer PDL may be on the via insulating layer **140** on which the first electrode **181** is disposed. The pixel defining layer PDL may be formed using an organic material. For example, the pixel defining layer PDL may include a photoresist, an acryl-based resin, a polyimide-based resin, a polyamide-based resin, a siloxane-based resin, etc. In an example embodiment, an opening which exposes the first electrode **181** may be formed by etching the pixel defining layer PDL. An emitting area and a non-emitting area of the display apparatus may be defined by the opening of the pixel defining layer PDL. For example, a portion where the opening of the pixel defining layer PDL is located may correspond to an emitting area, and a non-emitting area may correspond to a portion adjacent to the opening of the pixel defining layer PDL.

(43) The light emitting layer **182** may be on the first electrode **181** exposed through the opening of the pixel defining layer PDL. In addition, the light emitting layer **182** may extend on a sidewall of the opening of the pixel defining layer PDL. In an example embodiment, the light emitting layer **182** may include an organic light emitting layer (EL), a hole injection layer (HIL), a hole transfer layer (HTL), an electron transfer layer (ETL), an electron injection layer (EIL), etc. In an example embodiment, the hole injection layer, the hole transport layer, the electron transport layer, and the electron injection layer may be formed in common to correspond to a plurality of pixels. In an example embodiment, a plurality of organic light emitting layers may be formed using light emitting materials for generating different colors of light such as a red color of light, a green color of light and a blue color of light in accordance with color pixels of the display device. In an example embodiment, the organic light emitting layer of the light emitting layer **182** may include a plurality of stacked light emitting materials for generating a red color of light, a green color of light and a blue color of light to thereby emitting a white color of light. Elements of the light emitting layer **182** may be commonly formed so as to correspond to a plurality of pixels, and each pixel may be divided by a color filter layer.

(44) The second electrode **183** may be on the pixel defining layer PDL and the light emitting layer **182**. The second electrode **183** may include a transmissive material or a reflective material in accordance with the emission type of the display device. In an example embodiment, the second electrode **183** may have a single layer structure or a multi-layer structure, which may include a metal film, an alloy film, a metal nitride film, a conductive metal oxide film, and/or a transparent conductive film.

(45) The thin film encapsulation layer TFE may be on the second electrode **183**. The thin film encapsulation layer TFE may prevent penetration of moisture and oxygen from outside. The thin film encapsulation layer TFE may include at least one organic layer and at least one inorganic layer. The at least one organic layer and the at least one inorganic layer may be alternately stacked with each other. For example, the thin film encapsulation layer TFE may include two inorganic layers and one organic layer therebetween. In an example embodiment, a sealing substrate may be provided for shielding outside air and moisture from penetrating into the display apparatus, instead of providing the thin film encapsulation layer TFE.

(46) According to an example embodiment, in order to form a folding area, an inorganic film may be removed, an electrode may be formed before an insulating pattern is formed, and an electrode may be configured to apply a ground voltage or a constant voltage to a conductive layer disposed between the thin film transistor and the base substrate. In such a structure, the display quality may be improved.

(47) FIG. **4** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(48) Referring to FIG. **4**, the display apparatus is substantially the same as the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3** except that it further includes a second conductive layer **103**, and the second conductive layer **103** is electrically connected to an electrode GD. Therefore, a repeated explanation may be omitted.

(49) The display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a conductive layer **108**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern (ACT), a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern including a wiring GL, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulation layer TFE.

(50) The base substrate **100** may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a second conductive layer **103** on the first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104** on the second conductive layer **103**, and a second polyimide layer **106** on the barrier film layer **104**. The second conductive layer **103** may be an n+ doped amorphous silicon (a-Si) layer like the conductive layer **108**.

(51) In a folding area FA, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the conductive layer **108**, the second polyimide layer **106**, the barrier film layer **104**, and the second conductive layer **103** to expose side surfaces of the conductive layer **108** and the second conductive layer **103**.

(52) The electrode GD may be in the contact hole. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole that exposes the side surface of the conductive layer **108** and the side surface of the second conductive layer **103**, so that the side surface of the conductive layer **108** and the side surface of the second conductive layer **103** may contact the electrode GD.

(53) In an implementation, the contact hole may be formed only up to the barrier film layer **104**, the second conductive layer **103** may not be removed, and an upper surface of the second conductive layer **103** may contact the electrode GD.

(54) FIG. **5** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(55) Referring to FIG. **5**, the display apparatus is substantially the same as the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3** except that the display apparatus includes a second conductive layer **103** instead of a conductive layer **108**, and the second conductive layer **103** is electrically connected to an electrode

GD. Therefore, repeated explanation may be omitted.

(56) The display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern including a wiring GL, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulating layer TFE.

(57) The base substrate **100** may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a second conductive layer **103** on the first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104** on the second conductive layer **103**, and a second polyimide layer **106** on the barrier film layer **104**.

(58) In the folding area FA, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the second polyimide layer **106**, the barrier film layer **104**, and the second conductive layer **103** to expose the second conductive layer **103**.

(59) The electrode GD may be disposed within the contact hole. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole that exposes a side surface of the second conductive layer **103**, and may contact the side surface of the second conductive layer **103**.

(60) In an implementation, the contact holes may be formed only up to the barrier film layer **104**, so that the second conductive layer **103** may not be removed, and an upper surface of the second conductive layer **103** may contact the electrode GD.

(61) FIG. **6** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(62) Referring to FIG. **6**, the display apparatus is substantially the same as the display apparatus of FIG. **5** except that the display apparatus further includes a third conductive layer **105**. Therefore, repeated explanation may be omitted.

(63) The display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a conductive layer **108**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern including a wiring GL, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulating layer TFE.

(64) The base substrate **100** may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a second conductive layer **103** on the first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104** on the second conductive layer **103**, a third conductive layer **105** on the barrier film layer **104**, and a second polyimide layer **106** on the third conductive layer **105**. The third conductive layer **105** may be an n+ doped amorphous silicon (a-Si) layer like the conductive layer **108**.

(65) In the folding area FA, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the conductive layer **108**, the second polyimide layer **106**, the third conductive layer **105**, the barrier film layer **104**, and the second conductive layer **103** to expose the second conductive layer **103**.

(66) The electrode GD may be disposed within the contact hole. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole exposing a side surface of the conductive layer **108**, a side surface of the third conductive layer **105**, a side surface of the second conductive layer **103** and may contact the side surface of the second conductive layer **103**.

(67) In an implementation, the contact hole may be formed only up to the barrier film layer **104**, and the second conductive layer **103** may not be removed, and an upper surface of the second conductive layer **103** may make contact the electrode GD.

(68) FIG. **7** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(69) Referring to FIG. **7**, the display apparatus is substantially the same as the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3**, except that a third conductive layer **105** is formed instead of a conductive layer **108**, and a contact hole is formed to a portion of the barrier film layer **104**. Therefore, repeated explanation may be omitted.

(70) The display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern

ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern including a wiring GL, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulating layer TFE. (71) The base substrate **100** may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104** on the first polyimide layer **102**, and a third conductive layer **105** on the barrier film layer **104**, and a second polyimide layer **106** on the third conductive layer **105**.

(72) In the folding area FA, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the second polyimide layer **106**, the third conductive layer **105**, and a portion of the barrier film layer **104** to expose a side surface of the third conductive layer **105**.

(73) The electrode GD may be disposed within the contact hole. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole that exposes the side surface of the third conductive layer **105**, and may contact the side surface of the third conductive layer **105**.

(74) FIG. **8** is a cross-sectional view illustrating a display apparatus according to an example embodiment.

(75) Referring to FIG. **8**, the display apparatus is substantially the same as the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3**, except for a base substrate **100**. Therefore, repeated explanation may be omitted.

(76) The display apparatus may include a base substrate **100**, a conductive layer **108**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, an interlayer insulating layer **130**, an electrode GD, an insulating pattern **135**, a data pattern including a drain electrode DE and a wiring GL, a via insulating layer **140**, a pixel defining layer PDL, and a thin-film encapsulating layer TFE.

(77) The base substrate **100** may be made of a transparent or opaque material. For example, the base substrate **100** may be a quartz substrate, a synthetic quartz substrate, a calcium fluoride substrate, a fluorine-doped quartz substrate, a sodalime glass substrate, an alkali-free non-alkali glass substrates, and the like.

(78) In a peripheral area PA, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the conductive layer **108**, and a portion of the base substrate **100** to expose a side surface of the conductive layer **108**.

(79) The electrode GD may be in the contact hole. Thus, the electrode GD may be in the contact hole that exposes the side surface of the conductive layer **108**, and may contact the side surface of the conductive layer **108**.

(80) FIGS. **9A** to **9I** are cross-sectional views illustrating stages in a method of forming the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3**.

(81) Referring to FIG. **9A**, a conductive layer **108** may be formed on a base substrate **100**. The base substrate **100** may include a first polyimide layer **102**, a barrier film layer **104**, and a second polyimide layer **106**. The conductive layer **108** may be formed by forming an amorphous silicon (a-Si) layer on the base substrate **100** and then doping with an impurity. For example, the conductive layer **108** may be an n+ doped amorphous silicon layer.

(82) Referring to FIG. **9B**, a buffer layer **110**, an active pattern ACT, a gate insulating layer **120**, a gate pattern including a gate electrode GE, and an interlayer insulating layer **130** may be sequentially formed on the conductive layer **108**.

(83) For example, the buffer layer **110**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the interlayer insulating layer may be formed by a chemical vapor deposition process, a spin coating process, a plasma enhanced chemical vapor deposition process, a sputtering process, a vacuum deposition process, a high-density plasma-chemical vapor deposition process, a printing process, or the like.

(84) For example, an amorphous silicon layer may be formed on the buffer layer **110**, and then the amorphous silicon layer may be crystallized to form a polysilicon layer. Then, the active pattern ACT may be formed by patterning the polysilicon layer by a photolithography method or the like.

(85) For example, the gate pattern may be formed by forming a conductive film on the gate

insulating layer **120**, and patterning the conductive film using a photolithography process or an etching process using an additional etching mask. The conductive layer may be formed using a printing process, a sputtering process, a chemical vapor deposition process, a pulsed laser deposition (PLD) process, a vacuum deposition process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD) process, and the like.

(86) Referring to FIG. **9C**, a source contact hole SCNT and a drain contact hole DCNT may be formed to expose the active pattern ACT through the interlayer insulating layer **130** and the gate insulating layer **120**.

(87) The source contact hole SCNT and the drain contact hole DCNT may be formed by forming a photoresist layer on the interlayer insulating layer **130**, and then exposing and developing the photoresist layer to form a photoresist pattern, and then partially etching the interlayer insulating layer **130** and the gate insulating layer **120** using the photoresist pattern as an etching barrier.

(88) Referring to FIG. **9D**, a contact hole CNT exposing a side surface of the conductive layer **108** may be formed. For example, portions corresponding to the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110** in the folding are FA which are inorganic insulation layers may be removed. At this time, a contact hole may be formed through the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, the buffer layer **110**, the conductive layer **108**, and the second polyimide layer, where an electrode (refer to GD of FIG. **9E**) will be formed, to expose the side surface of the conductive layer **108**.

(89) The contact hole CNT may be formed by forming a photoresist layer on the interlayer insulating layer **130**, exposing and developing the photoresist layer to form a photoresist pattern, and then partially etching the interlayer insulating layer **130** and the gate insulating layer **120**.

(90) Here, a depth of the contact hole CNT may vary according to the process and the structure of the display apparatus. The depth may be enough to expose the conductive layer **108** (to expose the second or third conductive layer in other embodiments).

(91) The order of forming the contact holes CNT, the source contact holes SCNT, and the drain contact holes DCNT may be changed, or they may be formed simultaneously using a halftone mask or the like.

(92) Referring to FIG. **9E**, the electrode GD may be formed in the contact hole CNT to contact the side surface of the conductive layer **108**. The electrode GD may extend along a side surface of the contact hole CNT and may extend to an upper surface of the interlayer insulating layer **130** for connection with a wiring (refer to GL in FIG. **9G**) described below.

(93) Referring to FIG. **9F**, an insulating pattern **135** may be formed in the contact hole CNT on which the electrode GD is formed. The insulating pattern **135** may be formed to correspond to the portion where the interlayer insulating layer **130**, the gate insulating layer **120**, and the buffer layer **110**, which are the inorganic insulation layers, are removed. The insulating pattern **135** may be formed to reduce a step with the interlayer insulating layer **130** in the folding area FA. In the drawing, a step is shown as being formed with the interlayer insulating layer **130**, but the step may be minimized.

(94) The insulating pattern **135** may expose a portion of the electrode GD formed up to the upper surface of the interlayer insulating layer **130**.

(95) Referring to FIG. **9G**, a data pattern including a wiring GL, a source electrode SE, and a drain electrode DE may be formed on the insulating pattern **135** and the interlayer insulating layer **130**.

(96) Referring to FIG. **9H**, a via insulating layer **140** may be formed on the interlayer insulating layer **130** on which the data pattern is formed. A pixel contact hole PCNT exposing the drain electrode DE and an opening OP exposing a ground terminal PE_G (which is a portion of the wiring GL) may be formed through the via insulating layer **140**.

(97) Referring to FIG. **9I**, a light emitting layer **182**, a second electrode **183**, and a thin film encapsulation layer TFE may be formed on the via insulating layer **140** to form the display apparatus. The first electrode **181**, the pixel defining layer PDL, the light emitting layer **182**, the

second electrode **183**, and the thin film encapsulation layer TFE may be formed through various suitable methods, and the details are omitted.

(98) According to an example embodiment, when the conductive layer **108** is formed and the inorganic insulation layers in the folding area FA are removed, the contact hole CNT, the electrode GD, the insulating pattern **135**, and the wiring GL may be formed. Thus, display quality may be improved by a relatively simple structure and process.

(99) In FIGS. **9A** to **9I**, the method of manufacturing the display apparatus of FIGS. **1** to **3** has been described. The display apparatus of FIGS. **4** to **8** may be manufactured in a similar manner.

(100) FIG. **10** is a block diagram illustrating an electronic device according to an example embodiment. FIG. **11A** is a diagram illustrating an example in which the electronic device of FIG. **10** is implemented as a television. FIG. **11B** is a diagram illustrating an example in which the electronic device of FIG. **10** is implemented as a smart phone.

(101) Referring to FIGS. **10** through **11B**, the electronic device **500** may include a processor **510**, a memory device **520**, a storage device **530**, an input/output (I/O) device **540**, a power supply **550**, and a display device **560**. The display device **560** may correspond to the display apparatus of FIG. **1**. In addition, the electronic device **500** may further include a plurality of ports for communicating with a video card, a sound card, a memory card, a universal serial bus (USB) device, other electronic devices, etc. In an example embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. **11A**, the electronic device **500** may be implemented as a television. In another example embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. **11B**, the electronic device **500** may be implemented as a smart phone. In other examples, the electronic device **500** may be implemented as a cellular phone, a video phone, a smart pad, a smart watch, a tablet PC, a car navigation system, a computer monitor, a laptop, a head mounted display (HMD), etc.

(102) The processor **510** may perform various computing functions. The processor **510** may be a microprocessor, a central processing unit (CPU), an application processor (AP), etc. The processor **510** may be coupled to other components via an address bus, a control bus, a data bus, etc. Further, the processor **510** may be coupled to an extended bus such as a peripheral component interconnection (PCI) bus. The memory device **520** may store data for operations of the electronic device **500**. For example, the memory device **520** may include at least one non-volatile memory device such as an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM) device, an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM) device, a flash memory device, a phase change random access memory (PRAM) device, a resistance random access memory (RRAM) device, a nano floating gate memory (NFGM) device, a polymer random access memory (PoRAM) device, a magnetic random access memory (MRAM) device, a ferroelectric random access memory (FRAM) device, etc., and/or at least one volatile memory device such as a dynamic random access memory (DRAM) device, a static random access memory (SRAM) device, a mobile DRAM device, etc. The storage device **530** may include a solid state drive (SSD) device, a hard disk drive (HDD) device, a CD-ROM device, etc. The I/O device **540** may include an input device such as a keyboard, a keypad, a mouse device, a touchpad, a touch-screen, etc., and an output device such as a printer, a speaker, etc. The power supply **550** may provide power for operations of the electronic device **500**.

(103) The display device **560** may be coupled to other components via the buses or other communication links. In an example embodiment, the display device **560** may be included in the I/O device **540**. According to an example embodiment, the display device **560** may include an electrode in a folding area and to which a ground voltage or a constant voltage is applied, and a conductive layer electrically connected to the electrode and overlapping a thin film transistor, so that display quality may be improved.

(104) Example embodiments may be applied to organic light emitting display devices and various electronic devices including the same. For example, example embodiments may be applied to a mobile phone, a smart phone, a video phone, a smart pad, a smart watch, a tablet PC, a car

navigation system, a television, a computer monitor, a notebook, and the like.

(105) By way of summation and review, in a display apparatus that includes a thin film transistor, when characteristics of the thin film transistor (such as the threshold voltage V_{th}) change depending on external factors, the display quality may be degraded.

(106) As described above, example embodiments relate to a display apparatus that may exhibit improved display quality, and a method of manufacturing the display apparatus.

(107) Example embodiments may provide a display apparatus capable of improving display quality by stabilizing characteristics of the thin film transistor.

(108) According to an example embodiment, in order to form a folding area, an inorganic film is removed, an electrode is formed before an insulating pattern is formed, and the electrode is configured to apply a ground voltage or a constant voltage to a conductive layer disposed between a thin film transistor and a base substrate. Therefore, the display quality may be improved.

(109) Example embodiments have been disclosed herein, and although specific terms are employed, they are used and are to be interpreted in a generic and descriptive sense only and not for purpose of limitation. In some instances, as would be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art as of the filing of the present application, features, characteristics, and/or elements described in connection with a particular embodiment may be used singly or in combination with features, characteristics, and/or elements described in connection with other embodiments unless otherwise specifically indicated. Accordingly, it will be understood by those of skill in the art that various changes in form and details may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention as set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. A method of manufacturing a display apparatus, the method comprising: forming a conductive layer on a base substrate; forming a buffer layer on the conductive layer; forming an active pattern on the buffer layer; forming an insulating layer on the active pattern; forming a contact hole by partially removing the insulating layer and the buffer layer to expose the conductive layer; forming an electrode that contacts the conductive layer in the contact hole; forming an insulating pattern on the electrode so as to expose a portion of the electrode with a portion of the insulating pattern disposed in the contact hole; and forming a wiring on the insulating pattern, the wiring being electrically connected to the electrode.
2. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the conductive layer is an n+ doped amorphous silicon layer.
3. The method as claimed in claim 1, further comprising: forming a gate electrode on the insulating layer before forming the contact hole; and forming an interlayer insulating layer on the gate electrode, wherein in forming the contact hole, the contact hole is formed by partially removing the interlayer insulating layer, the insulating layer, and the buffer layer.
4. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein in forming the contact hole, a portion of the conductive layer is removed so as to penetrate completely through the conductive layer such that a side surface of the conductive layer is exposed, and the side surface of the conductive layer directly contacts the electrode.
5. The method as claimed in claim 4, wherein the electrode directly contacts the side surface of the conductive layer in the contact hole.
6. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the base substrate includes at least one polyimide layer and at least one barrier film layer.
7. A method of manufacturing a display apparatus, the method comprising: forming a conductive layer on a base substrate; forming a buffer layer on the conductive layer; forming an active pattern on the buffer layer; forming an insulating layer on the active pattern; forming a contact hole by partially removing the insulating layer, the buffer layer, and the conductive layer; forming an

electrode that contacts the conductive layer in the contact hole; forming an insulating pattern on the electrode so as to expose a portion of the electrode; and forming a wiring on the insulating pattern, the wiring directly connected to the electrode both at one location at a first side of the contact hole and at a second location spaced apart from the first side of the contact hole.

8. The method as claimed in claim 7, wherein in forming the contact hole, a portion of the conductive layer is removed so as to penetrate completely through the conductive layer such that a side surface of the conductive layer is exposed, and the side surface of the conductive layer directly contacts the electrode in the contact hole.

9. The method as claimed in claim 8, wherein the wiring makes direct contact with both a top surface of the electrode and a side surface of the electrode.

10. The method as claimed in claim 7, wherein the wiring makes direct contact with both a top surface of the electrode and a side surface of the electrode.

11. The method as claimed in claim 7, wherein a portion of the insulating pattern is in the contact hole.

12. The method as claimed in claim 7, wherein in forming the contact hole, a portion of the substrate is removed such that a side surface of the conductive layer is exposed, and the side surface of the conductive layer directly contacts the electrode in the contact hole.
